SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PLC AGENDA

Use the Rubric to Read Student Writing and Plan the Next Step

Science Literacy Learning Cycle — Read completed student writing against the rubric, write one comment students can act on, and choose one next instructional step toward the standard.

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026 | **46 MINUTES** | **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with an agreed rubric or success criteria, evidence from 3–5 completed writing samples, one written feedback comment students can act on, one next instructional step, and one evidence check for the standard.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS A rubric gives every teacher and student the same definition of strong writing. Reading completed work against that shared bar makes feedback specific and keeps the next step tied to the standard instead of a general reteach.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Questions 1, 3, and 4; Team Deep Dive Steps 3–5; After-Lesson Reflection: clarify the standard and student product, read evidence in the work against the rubric, respond with feedback, and adjust practice for the next learning experience.

WHAT TO BRING
3–5 completed student writing samples; the task and source; the rubric or success criteria you use; and the Lesson Internalization Tool. Biology may bring the Benchmark #1 rubric; every other course brings its own comparable rubric or success criteria.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
The rubric leads and is used every time. Underline the one or two criteria under review, describe what the writing shows, and shape the priority need with what you know about your students. Keep the feedback and next step tied to those criteria. The rubric describes the writing; it does not rank students, teachers, classes, or courses.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
0:00–4:00	**Open the cycle + materials**	Revisit the task and the writing students produced. Set out the rubric and today's five steps; each step produces one product.	**Purpose + steps**
4:00–10:00	**Step 1: Start with the rubric**	Name the task, standard, and student product. Underline the one or two criteria under review and agree on what meeting them looks like.	**Rubric criteria**
10:00–22:00	**Step 2: Read 3–5 samples with the rubric**	Read each sample next to the rubric. Quote what shows the criterion and name the criterion that is missing or partial.	**Writing evidence**
22:00–30:00	**Step 3: Name the pattern + priority need**	State one strength and one rubric-based need that appears across samples. Keep it to one need, not a list.	**Priority need**
30:00–37:00	**Step 4: Give clear feedback**	Write one short comment: say what is missing, tell students where to look, and tell them what to revise. Do not give the answer.	**Feedback comment**
37:00–43:00	**Step 5: Plan the next instructional step**	Choose one next step for the priority criterion and one short evidence check. Complete the writing analysis tool.	**Next step + check**
43:00–46:00	**Close + carry forward**	Confirm the feedback, the revision, and the evidence to collect next. Keep the samples and the form for the next PLC.	**Evidence commitment**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Read and plan independently first. Then use colleagues to check one thing: does the written feedback match the evidence in the student work, and will it move the same standard forward?

1. **Start with the rubric:** Name the task and standard, then underline the criteria under review.
2. **Read the samples:** Read 3–5 pieces against the rubric and describe what the writing shows.
3. **Name the pattern:** State one strength and one rubric criterion that needs work.
4. **Give clear feedback:** Say what is missing, where to look, and what to revise.
5. **Plan the next step:** Choose one step and one evidence check, then complete the tool.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

THE RUBRIC IS THE ANCHOR
Underline the one or two criteria you are reviewing. The rubric gives everyone the same bar and is used every time, alongside what the writing shows and what you know about your students. It never ranks students, teachers, classes, or courses.

FEEDBACK STUDENTS CAN ACT ON
Every comment says what is missing, tells students where to look, and tells them what to revise. Feedback shows the way; it does not supply the answer.

ONE NEXT STEP, ONE CHECK
Choose one next instructional step for the priority criterion, then collect one short piece of new evidence to see whether that criterion improved.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.

TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-A-1 Reflective Practice • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

01 **Start with the rubric**
Name the task and standard, then underline the 1–2 criteria under review.

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02 **Read 3–5 samples**
Read each piece against the rubric and describe what the writing shows.

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03 **Name the pattern**
State one strength and the one rubric need that matters most.

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04 **Give clear feedback**
Say what is missing, where to look, and what to revise.

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05 **Plan the next step**
Choose one step and one short evidence check, then complete the tool.

TODAY'S MOVE: rubric or success criteria → 3–5 student samples → one pattern + priority need → feedback students can act on → one next step + evidence check